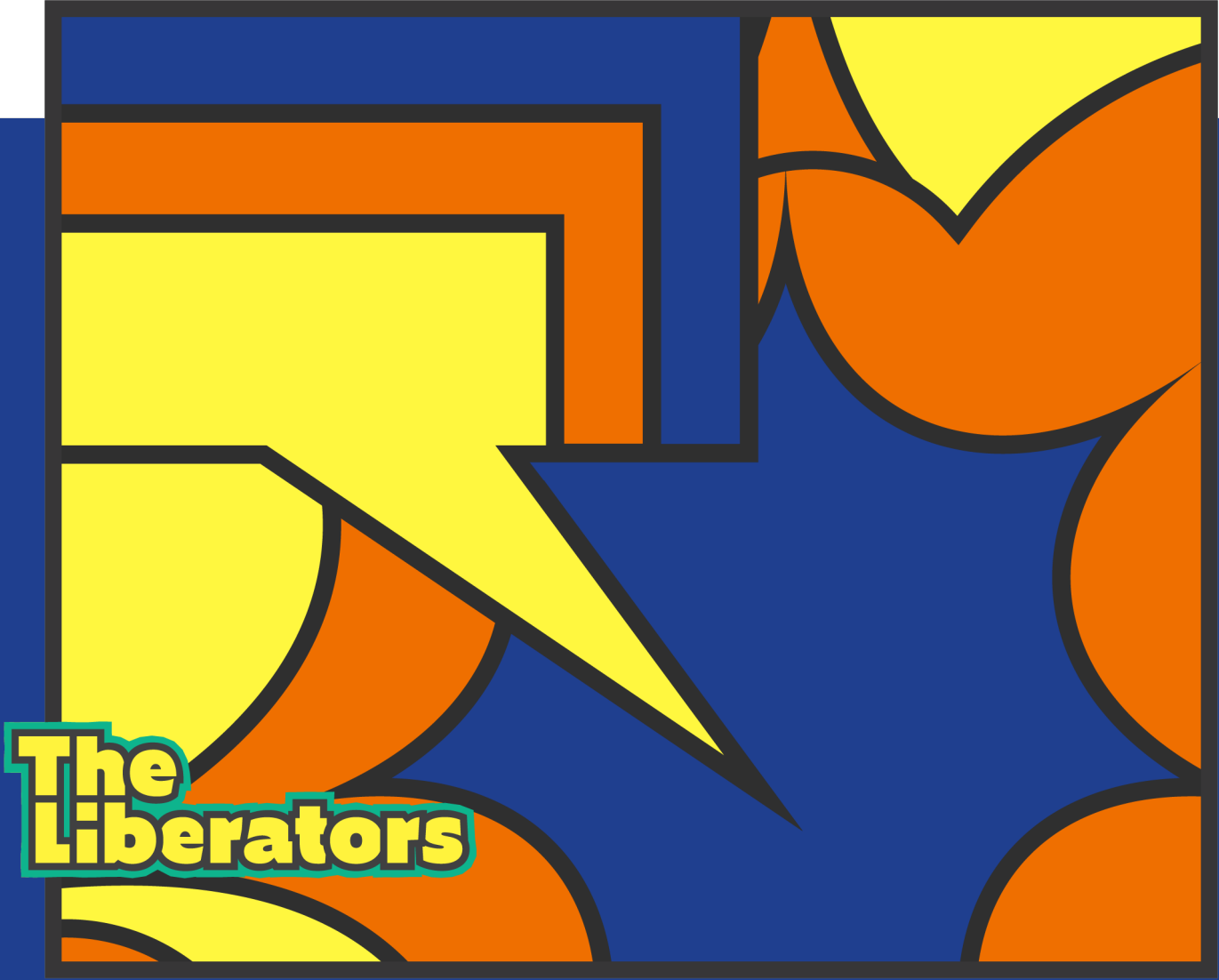


Refresh The Purpose Of The Scrum Framework

A simple experiment to help your team and organization re-clarify the purpose of Scrum

An abstract graphic featuring a dark blue background with large, bold, stylized shapes in orange and yellow. The shapes include a large yellow arrow pointing right, a yellow rectangle, and several orange and yellow curved shapes. The text "The Liberators" is written in a bold, yellow, sans-serif font with a black outline and a blue drop shadow, positioned in the bottom left corner of the graphic.

**The
Liberators**

The Purpose Of This Experiment

How would the people you work with complete the following sentence: "The Scrum framework exists in order to ..."? Sometimes we get bogged down in the rules and mechanics of Scrum while forgetting what we're trying to achieve in the first place. Or we don't even know what the point is, and go along because it is hip or what everyone else is doing. Either way, this is not a good foundation for improvement.

Zombie Scrum often starts when people misunderstand the purpose of the Scrum framework. Although it's easy to focus on the roles, the events, and the artifacts – the mechanics of Scrum – it is ultimately about shipping fast, involving stakeholders, autonomous teams and continuously improving to do this more effectively.

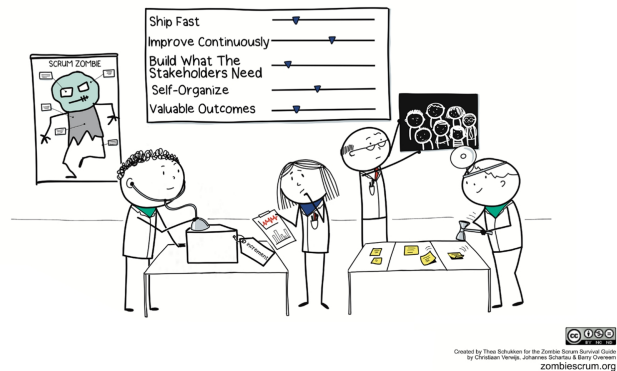
So, why not spend a part of your upcoming Sprint Retrospective to re-clarify the purpose of Scrum? Or re-iterate the purpose of Scrum at the start of the Sprint Review and Sprint Planning and how it connects to those events.

If you need help to clarify this for yourself, the [Scrum Guide](#) is an excellent start, followed by our [free whitepaper](#), and [this poster](#) that captures all the elements of the Scrum framework.

Give it a try and let us know how it went!

Barry & Christiaan

The Liberators



Difficulty / Effort

Required Skill



This experiment is very lightweight to use and doesn't require and special facilitation skills.

Impact On Survival

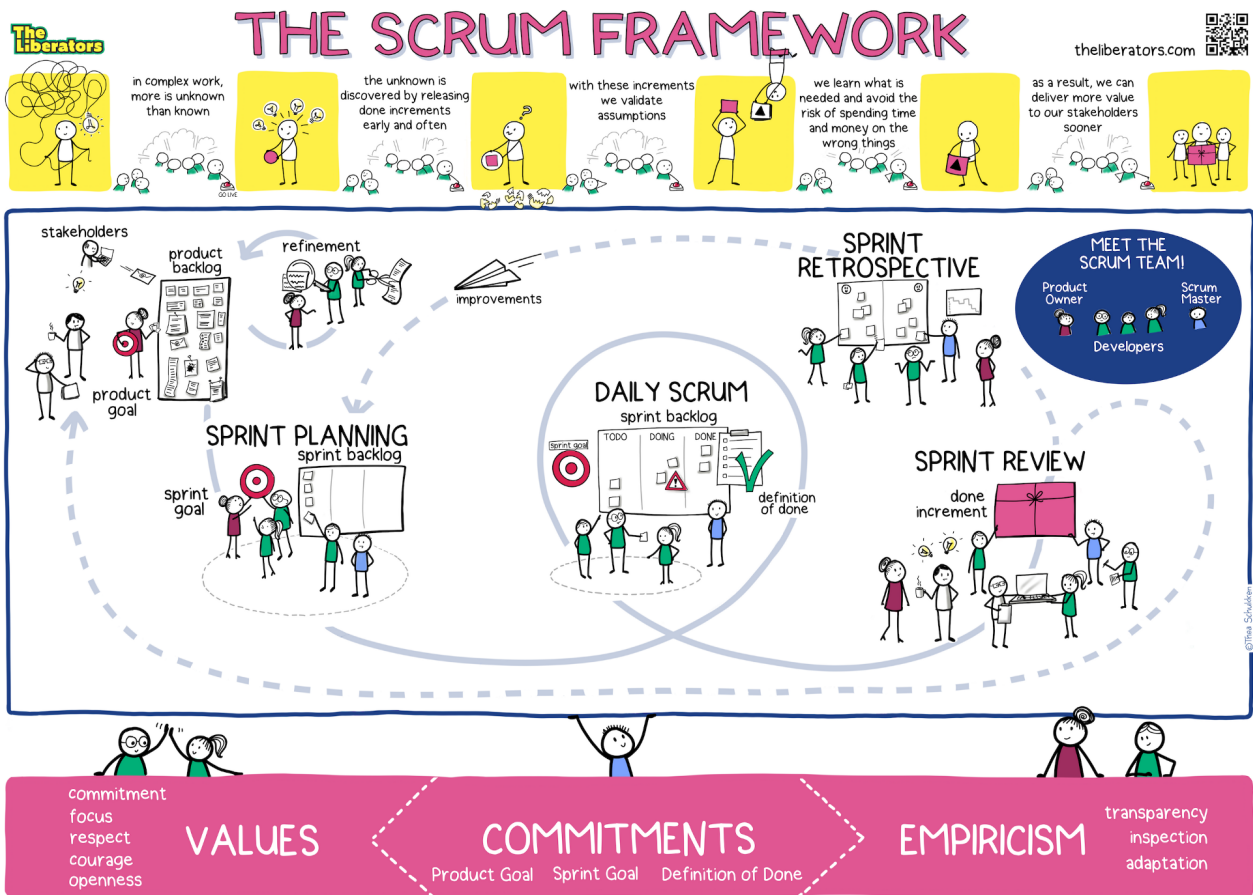


Understanding the purpose of Scrum sets a solid foundation to use it effectively and prevents misunderstandings.

Steps

To try this experiment, do the following:

1. **1 min** Invite people to individually, and in silence, compile a list of all the things they do as part of working with Scrum;
2. **10 min** Ask people to form pairs. Taking turns, people share their lists and ask each other "Why is this important?" for each item and for the list as a whole. Encourage people to keep asking "Why?" so that you can really drill down to the core;
3. **5 min** In their pairs, invite people to complete the sentence on a poster or a large sticky: "The Scrum framework exists in order to ...";
4. **10 min** The pairs share their sentences. As a group, pick the best one and refine it further. This is also an excellent opportunity to teach the purpose of Scrum if the team is struggling. Important keywords are value, "Done" increments, managing risk, validating assumptions, complexity, and predictability;
5. **25 min** Create five stations, each for one of the Scrum events and refinement of the Product Backlog. Invite people to form small groups. Each group picks one station to start. Give the groups 5 minutes to explore how this event serves the purpose identified in the previous round. What can be done to optimize how this event is done? After 5 minutes, ask the groups to move clockwise to the next station and build on what was written by the group before them. Repeat until every group has visited every station;
6. **10 min** Together, debrief the insights from the five stations. What are the biggest takeaways? What is one vital improvement that should be made for the next Sprint?



Our Findings



- During the first step of the exercise, you ask people to compile a list of all the things they do as part of working with Scrum. This could result in a list with individual activities, which is fine and makes it more personal. You can also encourage the participants to make a list of the activities they do as a Scrum team.
- This experiment focuses mostly on how the Scrum events connect to the purpose of Scrum. If the participants liked this exercise, consider creating stations with the roles, artifacts, or commitments. As such, you clarify those elements of Scrum as well. By using separate Sprint Retrospectives to explore all the parts of Scrum, you can keep the sessions short and focused. So, consider making it a series of Sprint Retrospectives!

Resources & Material

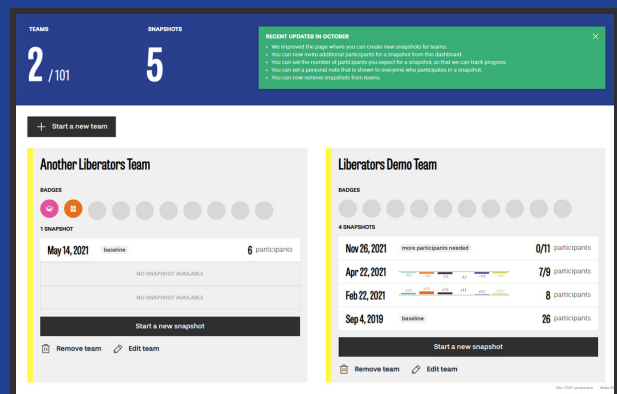
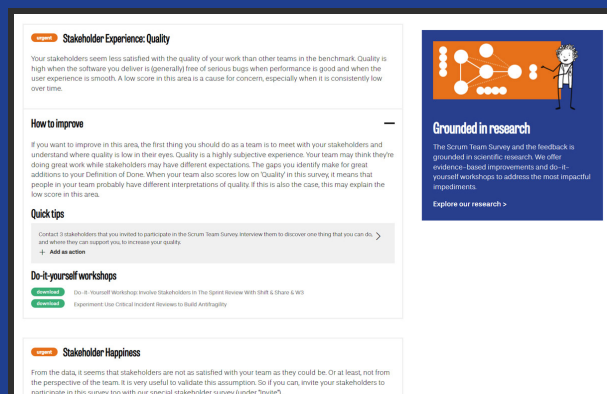
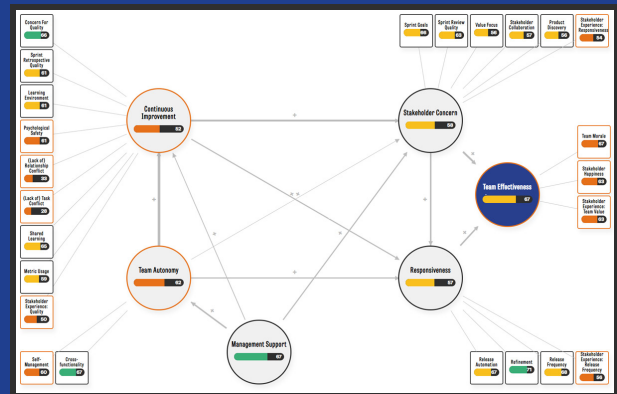
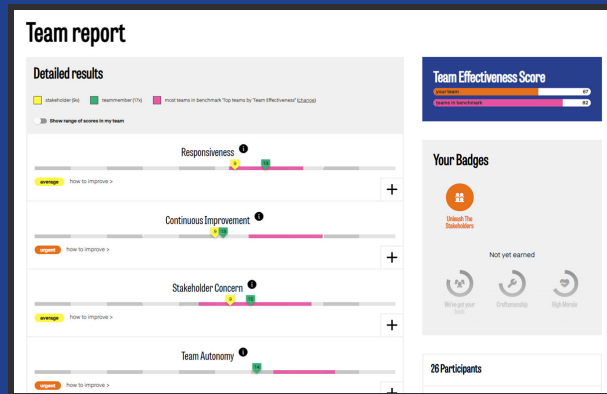


- Download a free [high-resolution version of the poster](#) in our webshop
- You can also order [a physical copy of this poster](#), printed on a large cotton banner
- Check out or on-going series of posts for [Scrum Mythbusters](#)
- Read [our whitepaper](#) where we explain the Scrum framework, and its principles and values, in our own words



Make Your Scrum Team More Effective

Want to make your Scrum team more effective? We created the Scrum Team Survey to help. Invite members and stakeholders to a detailed questionnaire and diagnose the results together. You receive tons of actionable feedback based on your results, including dozens of quick tips and useful do-it-yourself workshops. You can use the Scrum Team Survey for free with your team. No account or e-mail address is required. You can also subscribe for more advanced features.



	Essential	Liberator
Invite team members & stakeholders	unlimited	unlimited
Quick Tips for your team per topic	3	unlimited
Recommendations to your team	5	unlimited
Compare your team against different benchmarks		✓
Analyze the range of scores in your team		✓
Receive our personal guidance on how to get started		✓
See where your team improves over time with Team Trends		✓
Support our academic research to help more teams		✓
Pricing per team per month	€ 0	€ 10

<https://scrumteamsurvey.org>

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